Slide 1: Physical Pin, Lifecycle Flows, and Workforce

Author: Arika Khor | **Track:** Collecting Data (Training, Scraping, Labor) | **Topic:** Data Labeling

Specific Pick & Location Pin

- **Site:** ByteDance & TDCX Regional Data Delivery Center, The Horizon, Bangsar South, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia (3.1114° N, 101.6669° E).
- **Lifecycle Role:** Primary Southeast Asian operational hub for raw video categorization, content labeling, and safety filter training for TikTok and ByteDance algorithms.

Inputs and Outputs

- **Inputs:** Raw, uncurated short-form video and text streams scraped across ASEAN; continuous human visual and cognitive attention; desktop terminals and enterprise fiber networks.
- **Outputs:** Verified safety training labels, RLHF policy training datasets, and fine-tuned recommendation model parameters. Negative output includes acute occupational psychological trauma among annotators.

Ownership, Control, and Financing

- **Owner / Capital Pin:** ByteDance Global HQ at One Raffles Quay, Singapore (1.2818° N, 103.8526° E) and TDCX Corporate HQ at ESR BizPark @ Chai Chee, Singapore (1.3236° N, 103.9238° E).
- **Financing:** Funded via ByteDance corporate revenue, TikTok digital ad monetisation, and global venture capital pools.

Community and Workforce Profile

- **Host Community:** Bangsar South (Kerinchi), a redeveloped commercial BPO enclave in southwest Kuala Lumpur.
- **Workforce:** Young adult professionals (aged 21–35) with multilingual fluency across Malay, Indonesian, Tagalog, and English. Workers earn local BPO salaries of approximately $600 to $900 USD/month under automated quota surveillance.

Slide 2: Governance, Empirical Metrics, and Supply Chain Opacity

Author: Arika Khor | **Track:** Collecting Data (Training, Scraping, Labor) | **Topic:** Data Labeling

Governing Laws and Regulations

- **Labor Law:** Governed under the Malaysian Employment Act 1955, regulating basic contract terms, standard operating hours, and statutory termination notice periods.
- **Content Regulation:** Governed under the Malaysian Communications and Multimedia Act 1998 (CMA Sections 211 and 233), criminalizing the transmission of offensive, indecent, or menacing content online.

Verified Quantitative Impact Metric

- **Metric:** Over 500 workers were terminated in a single restructuring wave in October 2024 at ByteDance's Bangsar South hub as operations shifted to automated AI safety models.
- **Source Classification:** Journalism (Reuters investigative reporting, October 11, 2024, corroborated by Channel NewsAsia), verified through official statements from the Malaysian Ministry of Human Resources.
- **Empirical Verification:** Cross-referenced with ByteDance's global transparency disclosures, which report that over 80% of violating content is now removed automatically by machine learning systems trained on these workers' prior annotations.

Supply Chain Opacity and Missing Data

- **Non-Disclosure Agreements:** Strict NDAs prohibit workers from naming clients, discussing algorithmic annotation manuals, or disclosing daily review quotas.
- **Corporate Financial Secrecy:** Parent corporations keep profit margins opaque, shielding the financial spread between what ByteDance and TDCX bill in Singapore versus the wages paid in Kuala Lumpur.
- **Omitted Perspectives:** Long-term psychiatric trauma and worker mental health outcomes are withheld from public reporting.

Slide 3: Generative AI Comparative Audit & References

Author: Arika Khor | **Track:** Collecting Data (Training, Scraping, Labor) | **Topic:** Data Labeling

Generative AI Comparative Audit

- **Prompt Tested:** “Analyze the labor conditions, supply chain role, and corporate structure of ByteDance’s data labeling operations in Southeast Asia.”
- **What It Got Right:** Accurately identified that ByteDance uses outsourced labor in Malaysia and the Philippines for multilingual video labeling, and recognized Singapore as the regional corporate management center.
- **What It Hallucinated / Smoothed Over:** Relied heavily on corporate PR claims, asserting that workers receive “competitive tech salaries and comprehensive psychological care,” while ignoring high daily quotas where workers evaluate hundreds of videos per shift with under 15 seconds per review.
- **What It Missed:** Completely omitted the October 2024 mass layoffs in Malaysia, missing the reality that human data annotators were discarded once their training annotations made automated AI moderation viable. It also missed the cross-border capital extraction pipeline between Singapore and Malaysia.

Graduate Academic References

- Crawford, Kate. Atlas of AI: Power, Politics, and the Planetary Costs of Artificial Intelligence. Yale University Press, 2021. (Chapter 2: Labor).
- Roberts, Sarah T. Behind the Screen: Content Moderation in the Shadows of Social Media. Yale University Press, 2019.
- Latiff, Rozanna, and Danial Azhar. “ByteDance lays off hundreds of staff in Malaysia as it shifts toward AI moderation.” Reuters, October 11, 2024.
- TDCX Inc. Form 20-F Annual Report. US Securities and Exchange Commission, 2023.